MODULE V

PHILOSOPHICAL UNDERPINNING OF AI

AND THE FUTURE OF HUMANITY

In the module, we are assessing the four chapters through a process that entails debate and the exchange of thoughts. Evaluating the philosophical underpinnings of Artificial Intelligence reveals that AI surpasses simple technological progress, posing a profound philosophical quandary that engages with fundamental issues of human life. Philosophical discussions in mind, ethics, and epistemology clarify the degree to which computers may truly think, understand, or possess consciousness. Philosophical discussions initiated by thinkers such as Alan Turing and John Searle demonstrate that machine intelligence raises complex issues concerning the differentiation between simulation and genuine understanding. Despite AI systems performing tasks similar to human intelligence, the question of whether they possess true awareness or intentionality remains unresolved.

The proliferation of AI requires careful deliberation regarding accountability, fairness, and ethical judgement. As AI systems increasingly influence human life in areas such as government, healthcare, and economic structures, society must establish ethical standards to ensure that new technologies enhance human wellbeing rather than endanger it. Philosophical inquiry is essential in guiding the development and regulation of artificial intelligence.

The future of humanity in the age of AI will depend on the prudent amalgamation of scientific advancement with ethical responsibility and intellectual understanding. Artificial intelligence has the potential to greatly enhance human knowledge, productivity, and problem-solving capabilities. However, it also challenges our traditional notions of intelligence, agency, and human uniqueness. A balanced approach—merging scientific progress with philosophical reflection—will be essential to ensure that artificial intelligence functions as a tool that enriches and supports human civilisation rather than replacing or weakening it.